

Purpose: To encourage us to seek promptings from the Holy Ghost and to avoid attitudes and actions that will keep us from receiving these promptings.

1. Paul teaches, baptizes, and confers the Holy Ghost on believers in Ephesus.

- Read and discuss [Acts 18:23—19:41](#). “After Paul returned from his second mission, he spent some time in Antioch and then departed on a third mission (Acts 18:22-23). During this third mission he spent most of his time—nearly three years—preaching in Ephesus.” (*Lesson Manual*) †1. Acts 18:23. Commencement of Paul’s Third Missionary Journey

- Acts 18:24-28. “And a certain Jew named Apollos, ... mighty in the scriptures came to Ephesus.”

What qualities made Apollos teachable? How did these qualities also make him an effective teacher?
How can we develop these qualities?

- Acts 19:1-6. “6 ... the Holy Ghost came on them; and they spake with tongues, and prophesied.”

What manifestations of the Holy Ghost are frequently experienced today? †2. “Spirit Missing in Judaism”

- Acts 19:8-9. Paul “spoke boldly ... reasoning and persuading.” (New KJV; emphasis added)

†3. Elder Marvin J. Ashton

- Acts 19:23-28. “And the same time there arose no small stir about that way. For ... Demetrius, a silversmith ...”

How can concerns with wealth or worldly interests affect our ability to hear the promptings of the Spirit?

- Acts 19:18-19. Earlier Ephesians had given up “fifty thousand pieces of silver.”

How can we keep the proper perspective regarding earthly possessions?

2. Paul gives a farewell address to Church leaders from Ephesus.

- Read and discuss [Acts 20](#). †4. Paul’s further journeys and return to Ephesus

- [Acts 20:28-35](#). “... after my departing shall grievous wolves enter in among you, not sparing the flock.”

How can we guard against apostasy in our lives?

How can we help protect God’s flock from “grievous wolves”?

- Acts 20:35-38. “It is more blessed to give than to receive.”

How have you found this to be true in your life?

3. Paul chastises and counsels the Galatian Saints.

- Read and discuss [Galatians](#). “While Paul was on his third missionary journey, he wrote a letter to the Saints in Galatia, many of whom had returned to keeping the law of Moses. He chastised those who believed that salvation would come through the works required by the law of Moses rather than through faith in the Lord Jesus Christ.” (*Lesson Manual*; emphasis added)

- Galatians 3:23-26. “The law was our schoolmaster to bring us unto Christ”.

- [3 Ne. 15:2-5](#); [Alma 34:10](#); [3 Ne. 9:19](#). “Jesus fulfilled the law of Moses through his Atonement, which was symbolized by many of the law’s ordinances.” (*Lesson Manual*)

- Galatians 1:6; 4:9. “I marvel that ye are so soon removed from him [Christ] ... unto another gospel”.

- [Galatians 2:16](#); [3:5](#); [5:1-6](#). “Knowing that a man is not justified by the works of the law, but by the faith of Jesus Christ”.

Why are we not justified by the works of the law (of Moses)? †5. Justification †6. Sidney B. Sperry—Justification

How did this return to the law of Moses show a lack of faith in Christ? †7. Justification and Sanctification

- Galatians 1:11-12. Paul certifies the gospel is true “by the revelation of Jesus Christ.”

Why is it important that our testimonies are based on revelation from Jesus Christ?

- Galatians 5:19-21. “Now the works of the flesh are manifest, which are these”.

What are the consequences of doing the works of the flesh? (See verse 21.)

- [Galatians 5:16, 22-23, 25](#). “Walk in the Spirit, and ye shall not fulfill the lust of the flesh.”

How have these fruits of the Spirit been manifest in your life?

What if we feel an absence of these fruits in our lives?

- [Galatians 5:14](#); [6:2](#). “For all the law is fulfilled in one word ... Thou shalt love thy neighbour as thyself.”

- Galatians 5:7-9. “Be not deceived; God is not mocked: for whatsoever a man soweth, that shall he also reap.”

How do men and women mock God? How does it affect our ability to hear and follow the Spirit?

Next Week: L33 “Ye Are the Temple of God”; See L33: [Class Member Study Guide](#).

Read the Institute New Testament Student Manual at: [New Testament Student Manual: Religion 211-212](#).) † •

NT32 Quotes

†1. **Chapter 33: Acts 18:23. Commencement of Paul's Third Missionary Journey:** "Paul's third missionary journey, recorded in Acts 18:23–21:15, was the longest of his missions, both in terms of duration (three and a half to four years, about A.D. 54–58) and in distance covered (over 3,500 miles or 5,600 kilometers). Paul visited congregations he had established in his first two journeys, and spent three years at Ephesus, a location he had not previously visited (see Acts 19:10; 20:31). The account of Paul's third mission portrays his growing influence and effectiveness as a theologian, preacher, writer, and faithful servant of Jesus Christ. During this mission Paul wrote 1 and 2 Corinthians, Romans, and perhaps others of his epistles. During Paul's second mission he had spread word of the need to make a collection for the poor in Jerusalem. One of his prime concerns on his third journey was to collect these donated funds." (*New Testament Student Manual: Religion 211-212*, [Chapter 33: Acts 16-20](#). Scroll down to Acts 18:23. Commencement of Paul's Third Missionary Journey.)

†2. **"Spirit Missing in Judaism:"** "At a recent conference of scholars dealing with 'The Bible Code,' one orthodox Jew stated simply, 'Judaism does not have the Holy Spirit.' Readers can refer to previous statements and quotes in these supplements about the Holy Spirit. A repetition and other Jewish comments about the spirit are included for comparison. 'The rabbis regarded Haggai, Zechariah and Malachi as the last of the prophets, the "divine spirit" having ceased in Israel with their deaths.' " (Encyclopedia Judaica Jr.) (Daniel Rona, Hidden LDS/Jewish Insights, [NTGD Supplement #32, "Live in the Spirit,"](#) accessed 8/27/15.

†3. **Elder Marvin J. Ashton:** "When others disagree with our stand we should not argue, retaliate in kind, or contend with them. ... Ours is to explain our position through reason, friendly persuasion, and accurate facts. Ours is to stand firm and unyielding on the moral issues of the day and the eternal principles of the gospel, but to contend with no man or organization. Contention builds walls and puts up barriers. Love opens doors. ... Contention never was and never will be an ally of progress" ("[No Time for Contention](#)," Ensign, May 1978, 7–8).

†4. **Paul's further journeys and return to Ephesus:** "Paul left Ephesus and traveled throughout Macedonia and Greece, preaching the gospel. He planned to return to Jerusalem for the Feast of Pentecost. On his way back to Jerusalem, he sent a messenger to ask Church leaders in Ephesus to meet with him in Miletus. He delivered a stirring farewell address and then resumed his journey." (*Lesson Manual*)

†5. **Justification:** "Justification means 'to be declared righteous,' and also 'to be put back in to the right relationship with a person.' Therefore, what Paul was saying is that no man can be made righteous and reestablish the proper relationship with God exclusively by the works of the Mosaic law or, for that matter, by any law of works alone. This can come only through the atoning sacrifice of the Savior and through obedience." (1989, 1995 Gospel Doctrine Teacher's Manual, p.31; cited by Bill Beardall in [The Gospel Doctrine Class NT-Lesson 32](#).)

†6. **Sidney B. Sperry—Justification:** "... justification seems to anticipate for a Christian a decision of 'acquittal' or of being regarded as 'righteous' in a future Divine judgment. Can a member of the Church of Christ be regarded in the present time as being justified by faith? If he has truly been 'born again' of the Spirit and continues in a newness of life, we may answer 'yes.' In anticipation of his continued observance of the requirements of God, he may be regarded as 'acquitted' or as 'righteous,' and so is in Divine favor." (*Paul's Life and Letters*, p. 176; cited by Bill Beardall in [The Gospel Doctrine Class NT-Lesson 32](#).)

†7. **Justification and sanctification:** "Justification is a judicial act, whereby God declares that the sinner who repents and by faith accepts the sacrifice of the Lamb of God, and who is baptized according to the Word of God, is acquitted and received into His Kingdom.

"Sanctification is the work of the Holy Spirit by which he who is justified is enabled to keep the Commandments of God and grow in holiness (Helaman, 3:35)." (Doctrine and Covenants Commentary, p. 104; cited by Bill Beardall in [The Gospel Doctrine Class NT-Lesson 32](#).)

Recommended Reading:

1. [NT32 Enrichment.pdf](#) contains more quotes and links to articles, blogs, and talks.
2. *New Testament Student Manual: Religion 211-212*, [Chapter 33: Acts 16-20](#). Scroll down to Acts 18:23. Commencement of Paul's Third Missionary Journey.
3. *New Testament Student Manual: Religion 211-212*, [Chapter 43: Galatians](#).
4. Dallin H. Oaks, "[Revelation](#)," *New Era*, September 1982.
5. Map: [Paul's Third Missionary Journey](#), @ccel.org; accessed 8/26/15.
6. Elder Joseph B. Wirthlin, "[The Language of the Spirit](#)," *Ensign*, November 1975.
7. Elder Boyd K. Packer, "[Language of the Spirit](#)," *New Era*, March 1977.

Visit stephenmbird.com